EPADASH

PRODUCT RESEARCH & INITIAL USER JOURNEY DOCUMENT

INITIAL PRODUCT DISCOVERY • UI/UX DESIGN PHASE

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1.0 INTRODUCTION

This document explains how EpaDash should work for the people who will use it. It looks at what customers, riders and merchants need, the tasks they will carry out, and the screens they will use. It also covers the work administrators will do to keep the platform running. The aim is to give the design team a clear starting point before creating the screens in Figma.

2.0 PRODUCT OVERVIEW

EpaDash will make it easier for customers to find businesses, choose products and have their orders delivered. The platform will have four main parts:

- Customer Application: Allows customers to discover merchants, browse products, place orders, make payments and track deliveries.
- Rider Application: Enables delivery riders to receive requests, navigate to pickup and delivery locations, and manage deliveries.
- Merchant Portal: Allows businesses to manage their stores, products, incoming orders and sales.
- Administration Dashboard: Provides administrators with tools to manage users, merchants, riders, orders, payments and platform operations.

3.0 PRODUCT OBJECTIVES

- Provide customers with a convenient and reliable ordering experience.
- Help merchants reach more customers and manage online orders.
- Provide riders with an efficient delivery management system.
- Simplify communication between customers, merchants and riders.
- Enable order monitoring and delivery tracking.
- Provide administrators with centralised platform management tools.
- Support secure payments and transparent transaction management.

4.0 TARGET USERS AND USER PERSONAS

EpaDash is designed around three primary user groups and one administrative user group.

4.1 Customer Persona

A customer is an individual who uses EpaDash to discover businesses, browse products and place orders for delivery.

Primary needs: Simple registration and login; easy discovery of nearby merchants; product information and prices; convenient cart and checkout; multiple payment options; accurate delivery location selection; real-time order tracking; order history and support.

Expectations: Simple interface; fast order processing; transparent pricing and delivery fees; reliable delivery; timely notifications.

Primary goal: To order products conveniently and receive them at a preferred delivery location.

4.2 Rider Persona

A rider is responsible for collecting orders from merchants and delivering them to customers.

Primary needs: Easy registration; identity and facial verification; document submission and account approval; delivery requests; pickup and delivery information; navigation; customer and merchant contact; delivery confirmation; earnings and delivery history.

Expectations: Clear delivery instructions; accurate navigation; timely notifications; efficient assignment; reliable earnings information.

Primary goal: To receive, accept and complete delivery requests efficiently.

4.3 Merchant Persona

A merchant is a business owner or representative who uses EpaDash to manage a store, display products and fulfil customer orders.

Primary needs: Business registration and verification; store profile management; product and category management; inventory management; incoming order notifications; order acceptance and rejection; preparation updates; sales and earnings reports.

Expectations: Easy-to-use portal; efficient order management; accurate order information; reliable rider pickup coordination; clear sales and transaction records.

Primary goal: To manage the business effectively, receive customer orders and fulfil them successfully.

4.4 Administrator Persona

An administrator oversees the EpaDash platform and ensures customers, merchants and riders operate effectively.

Primary needs: Centralised platform management; customer account management; merchant and rider verification; order monitoring; rider assignment monitoring; payment monitoring; complaint management; reports and analytics.

Expectations: A clear operational overview; secure access; accurate records; tools to resolve issues quickly.

Primary goal: To maintain efficient platform operations and a reliable experience for all users.

5.0 CUSTOMER USER JOURNEY

This journey follows a customer from the moment they open EpaDash until their order arrives.

5.1 Customer Registration and Login

1. Customer opens the EpaDash application and views the splash and welcome screens.
2. Customer selects Create Account or Login.
3. Customer enters the required registration information.
4. Customer verifies their phone number through OTP.
5. Customer completes their profile and gains access to the application.

5.2 Merchant Discovery

6. Customer opens the home screen and confirms a delivery location.
7. The application displays available merchants.
8. Customer browses stores by category or searches for a merchant or product.
9. Customer selects a merchant and views store information, products and prices.

5.3 Product Selection and Cart Management

10. Customer browses available products and opens a product detail page.
11. Customer selects options or quantity and adds the product to the cart.
12. Customer continues shopping or opens the cart.
13. Customer reviews selected products, updates quantities or removes items.

5.4 Checkout and Payment

14. Customer proceeds to checkout and confirms the delivery address.
15. Customer adds delivery instructions if necessary.
16. The application displays the subtotal, delivery fee and other applicable charges.
17. Customer selects an available payment method and confirms the order.
18. Payment is processed and the application displays an order confirmation.

5.5 Order Processing and Rider Assignment

19. The order is sent to the selected merchant.
20. Merchant receives, reviews and accepts or rejects the order.
21. If accepted, the merchant prepares the order.
22. The system identifies an available rider and sends a delivery request.
23. Rider accepts the request and the customer receives a status update.

5.6 Order Tracking and Delivery Completion

24. Customer opens the order tracking screen.
25. Customer views order preparation and delivery status.
26. Customer receives notification when the rider collects the order.
27. Customer tracks the rider's location where live tracking is supported.
28. Rider arrives and completes the delivery confirmation process.
29. Customer receives a completion notification and can rate the experience.

6.0 RIDER USER JOURNEY

6.1 Rider Registration and Verification

30. Rider opens the EpaDash Rider application and selects Create Account.
31. Rider enters personal information and verifies their phone number.
32. Rider completes facial recognition verification.
33. Rider submits required identification and vehicle documents.
34. Administrator reviews the application.

35. Rider receives an approval or rejection notification.

6.2 Rider Availability

36. Approved rider logs into the application and accesses the dashboard.
37. Rider grants required location permissions.
38. Rider switches availability status to Online.
39. The system makes the rider eligible to receive delivery requests.

6.3 Delivery Request Acceptance

40. Rider receives a new delivery notification.
41. Rider reviews pickup location, delivery destination and order information.
42. Rider accepts or rejects the request.
43. If accepted, the delivery is assigned and pickup navigation is displayed.

6.4 Order Pickup

44. Rider navigates to the merchant's location.
45. Rider identifies the order and collects it from the merchant.
46. Rider confirms order collection.
47. The system updates the order status to Picked Up and notifies the customer.

6.5 Order Delivery

48. Rider navigates to the customer's delivery address.
49. Rider contacts the customer if necessary.
50. Rider hands over the order and completes the required delivery verification.
51. The system updates the order status to Delivered.
52. Rider views the completed delivery in their history.

6.6 Rider Earnings and History

53. Rider opens the earnings section.
54. Rider views completed deliveries and earnings.
55. Rider reviews transaction and payout information.
56. Rider accesses previous delivery records.

7.0 MERCHANT USER JOURNEY

7.1 Merchant Registration and Verification

57. Merchant opens the EpaDash Merchant Portal and selects Create Account.
58. Merchant enters personal and business information.
59. Merchant provides required business documents and submits registration.
60. Administrator reviews the information.
61. Merchant receives an approval or rejection notification.
62. Approved merchant gains access to the portal.

7.2 Store Setup and Configuration

63. Merchant logs into the portal and opens store setup.
64. Merchant uploads a store logo and cover image.
65. Merchant enters store name, description and business category.
66. Merchant enters store address and location.
67. Merchant configures operating hours and saves the information.

7.3 Product and Inventory Management

68. Merchant opens Product Management and selects Add Product.
69. Merchant enters product name, description and price.
70. Merchant uploads product images and assigns a category.
71. Merchant specifies available stock where applicable.
72. Merchant publishes the product and can later edit or deactivate it.

7.4 Order Management

73. Merchant receives a new order notification.
74. Merchant reviews products, quantities and customer instructions.
75. Merchant accepts or rejects the order.
76. If accepted, merchant prepares the order and updates its status.
77. Merchant marks the order Ready for Pickup.
78. Merchant hands the order to the assigned rider and confirms handover where required.
79. Merchant monitors the order until delivery completion.

7.5 Sales and Business Monitoring

80. Merchant accesses the dashboard.
81. Merchant views total orders and sales performance.
82. Merchant checks earnings and transactions.
83. Merchant reviews order history and product availability.

8.0 COMPLETE ORDERING AND DELIVERY WORKFLOW

Stage 1: Order Placement

- Customer discovers a merchant.
- Customer selects products and reviews the cart.
- Customer confirms checkout and completes payment or selects another supported payment method.

Stage 2: Merchant Processing

- Merchant receives the order.
- Merchant accepts or rejects the order.
- Accepted orders move into preparation.
- Merchant prepares products and marks the order Ready for Pickup.

Stage 3: Rider Assignment

- System identifies an available rider.
- Rider receives a delivery request.
- Rider accepts the request, navigates to the merchant and collects the order.

Stage 4: Order Delivery

- Rider confirms pickup.
- Customer receives a tracking update.
- Rider navigates to the customer and hands over the order.
- Rider confirms successful delivery.

Stage 5: Order Completion

- Order status changes to Delivered.
- Customer receives confirmation.
- Order is recorded in transaction history.
- Customer can submit a rating and review.

9.0 REQUIRED SCREENS AND INTERFACE COMPONENTS

9.1 Customer Application

Authentication and Onboarding

- Splash Screen
- Welcome Screen
- Create Account
- Login
- OTP Verification
- Password Recovery

Main Application

- Home Screen
- Search Screen
- Categories Screen
- Merchant Listing
- Merchant Details
- Product Details
- Shopping Cart
- Checkout
- Payment Selection
- Order Confirmation
- Order Tracking

Account and Support

- Customer Profile
- Address Management
- Order History
- Notifications
- Ratings and Reviews
- Help and Support
- Settings

9.2 Rider Application

Authentication and Verification

- Splash Screen
- Welcome Screen
- Rider Registration
- Login
- OTP Verification
- Facial Recognition
- Document Submission
- Application Status

Delivery Management

- Rider Dashboard
- Online/Offline Status
- Delivery Requests
- Delivery Details
- Pickup Navigation
- Pickup Confirmation
- Customer Navigation
- Delivery Confirmation

Account Management

- Earnings Dashboard
- Delivery History
- Rider Profile
- Notifications
- Help and Support
- Settings

9.3 Merchant Portal

Authentication and Business Setup

- Login
- Merchant Registration

- OTP Verification
- Business Information
- Document Submission
- Verification Status

Store Management

- Merchant Dashboard
- Store Profile
- Store Settings
- Product Management
- Add Product
- Edit Product
- Product Categories
- Inventory Management

Order and Business Operations

- Incoming Orders
- Order Details
- Order Processing
- Order Status Management
- Ready for Pickup
- Sales and Earnings
- Transaction History
- Promotions
- Notifications
- Support and Settings

9.4 Administration Dashboard

Authentication and Overview

- Admin Login
- Dashboard Overview
- Analytics and Reports

User Management

- Customer Management
- Rider Management
- Merchant Management
- Account Details
- Verification and Approval

Platform Operations

- Order Management

- Order Details
- Rider Assignment
- Delivery Monitoring
- Payment Management
- Refund Management
- Commission Management

Administration and Support

- Complaint Management
- Dispute Resolution
- Notifications Management
- Promotions Management
- Reports
- Platform Settings
- Admin Roles and Permissions

10.0 MAJOR INTERFACE COMPONENTS AND INTERACTIONS

Navigation Components

- Bottom navigation bar for mobile applications
- Sidebar navigation for web dashboards
- Top navigation bar
- Back buttons and navigation controls

Form Components

- Text input fields
- Password fields
- Phone number fields
- Dropdown selectors
- Search fields
- Address input fields
- Image and document upload components

Action Components

- Primary and secondary buttons
- Toggle switches
- Checkboxes and radio buttons
- Quantity selectors
- Add to Cart buttons
- Accept and Reject buttons
- Status update controls

Information Components

- Product cards
- Merchant cards
- Order summary cards
- Delivery request cards
- Notification cards
- Status badges
- Earnings and transaction cards
- Profile cards

Location and Tracking Components

- Interactive maps
- Location selection
- Navigation controls
- Rider location markers
- Delivery progress indicators

Feedback Components

- Success messages
- Error messages
- Confirmation dialogs
- Loading indicators
- Empty states
- Ratings and review components

11.0 ADMINISTRATIVE WORKFLOWS

11.1 Customer Management

- View registered customers.
- Search and filter customer accounts.
- View customer information.
- Suspend or deactivate accounts where necessary.
- Review customer complaints.

11.2 Rider Management

- View rider applications.
- Review submitted documents and verify identities.
- Approve or reject applications.
- Monitor rider availability and delivery history.
- Manage rider accounts.

11.3 Merchant Management

- View merchant applications.
- Review business information and submitted documents.
- Approve or reject businesses.
- Monitor store activity.
- Suspend or deactivate stores where necessary.

11.4 Order Management

- View all platform orders.
- Monitor order statuses and review order details.
- Monitor rider assignments.
- Manually reassign riders when necessary.
- Investigate delayed or failed deliveries.

11.5 Payment and Financial Management

- Monitor customer payments.
- Review merchant transactions and rider earnings.
- Manage refunds.
- Track platform commissions.
- Generate financial reports.

11.6 Support and Complaint Management

- Receive customer, merchant and rider complaints.
- Review reported issues.
- Assign complaints for resolution.
- Update complaint statuses.

12.0 SYSTEM NOTIFICATIONS AND ERROR STATES

12.1 Customer Notifications

- Account registration successful
- OTP verification successful or failed
- Order successfully placed
- Merchant accepted or rejected order
- Order preparation started
- Rider assigned
- Rider picked up order
- Rider approaching delivery location
- Order successfully delivered
- Payment successful or failed

12.2 Rider Notifications

- New delivery request
- Delivery request accepted
- Delivery request expired
- Order ready for pickup
- Customer delivery information updated
- Delivery successfully completed
- Account verification approved or rejected

12.3 Merchant Notifications

- New customer order
- Order accepted or rejected
- Order cancellation
- Rider assigned
- Rider arrived for pickup
- Order picked up
- Payment or transaction update

12.4 Important Error and Exception Scenarios

- Failed payments
- Unavailable products
- Merchant rejection
- Customer cancellation
- Rider rejection or unavailability
- Failed rider assignment
- Incorrect delivery addresses
- Customer unavailability
- Network connection problems
- Delayed deliveries

Each error or exception scenario should have an appropriate system response and clear feedback so users understand what happened and what action they can take next.

13.0 INITIAL FUNCTIONAL REQUIREMENTS

84. The platform must support customer, rider and merchant registration.
85. The platform must provide appropriate login and authentication processes.
86. Customers must be able to discover merchants and browse products.
87. Customers must be able to add products to a shopping cart and place orders.
88. The platform must calculate applicable order charges and delivery fees.
89. The platform must support the payment methods approved for launch.
90. Merchants must be able to receive and manage customer orders.

91. Riders must be able to receive and respond to delivery requests.
92. The system must support rider assignment and delivery status updates.
93. Customers must be able to monitor their order progress.
94. Administrators must be able to manage customers, riders and merchants.
95. The platform must provide order records and transaction history.
96. The system must provide notifications for important order activities.
97. The platform must provide appropriate security and verification mechanisms.

14.0 ASSUMPTIONS AND OUTSTANDING PRODUCT QUESTIONS

Product and Service Scope

- Will EpaDash support food delivery only or multiple product categories such as groceries and general merchandise?
- Will merchants be able to operate multiple store branches?
- Will customers be allowed to order from multiple merchants in one transaction?

Payment and Transactions

- Which payment methods will be supported?
- Will Mobile Money, bank cards and cash on delivery be available?
- How will merchant payments and rider earnings be processed?

Delivery Operations

- Will rider assignments be automatic, manual or a combination?
- Can riders reject delivery requests?
- How will the system handle unavailable riders?
- Will customers receive live rider location tracking?
- What delivery verification method will be used?

Platform Access

- Will the merchant portal be web-based, mobile-based or both?
- Will administrators be able to manually manage orders and rider assignments?
- What approval requirements will apply to riders and merchants?

The project team should discuss these questions and agree on the answers before the detailed Figma designs begin.

15.0 CONCLUSION

This document gives the EpaDash team a shared understanding of how the platform should work and what each type of user needs. It covers the customer ordering process, the rider's delivery tasks, the merchant's order management process and the work handled by administrators. It also lists the screens

and key features to consider during design. The team should review the document, agree on any open questions and approve it before moving into detailed Figma designs.

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